gang to keep the issue of Kashmir alive in international forums forever? It appears that Mountbatten had relented to the dictates of the British deep state and forcibly yanked Nehru and Patel along.

At this point, one cannot but wonder how and why the standstill agreement between Jammu and Kashmir and the Dominion of India remained unsigned, and who were the principal votaries who voted against it? If this agreement had been signed at independence, the Indian Government could have come to the aid of the Maharaja much earlier. Perhaps people were told that by signing the agreement, India would be taking a step towards recognising Kashmir's sovereignty and independence. The lack of a standstill agreement did not hinder the Maharaja of Patiala, in the first fortnight of October 1947, to dispatch a battalion of infantry and a battery of mountain artillery to Kashmir. When Indian troops, led by Lt. Col. D. R. Rai, landed in Srinagar on 27 October 1947, they found Patiala gunners guarding Srinagar airfield, where they had been in control since 17 October.

Gilgit Erupts

At the same time, frequent cipher messages were being exchanged between Col. Bacon in Peshawar and Maj. Brown in Gilgit. Because of what happened with Kalkat,[17] the British mercenaries had to stand down and the opportunity to cleanly take over Srinagar and the entire valley had been lost. *Pax Britannica* had clearly failed, and they had to resort to the use of communal arms to achieve its ends. Col. Bacon was concerned that matters in Gilgit would get similarly messy. On 28 October 1947, Brown received word that the Mehtar of Chitral was mobilising forces to join Maj. Brown's proposed joint command, that would offer stiff guerrilla resistance to an expected ascent by the Indian Army towards Gilgit. Similarly, the forces of the Wali of Swat had entered Tangir and were posted on the borders of the Gilgit Agency. On 29 October 1947, at the instructions of Col. Bacon, Brown readied for the execution of a bloodless coup by providing Governor Ghansara Singh a chance to step down with a promised safe passage out of